

Building Relationships

by

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Why relationship?

- **Necessary for survival: food, water, and shelter.**
- **Necessary for feeling of safety.**
- **Finally, individuals seek 'more human contacts'.**

Tips for communicators:

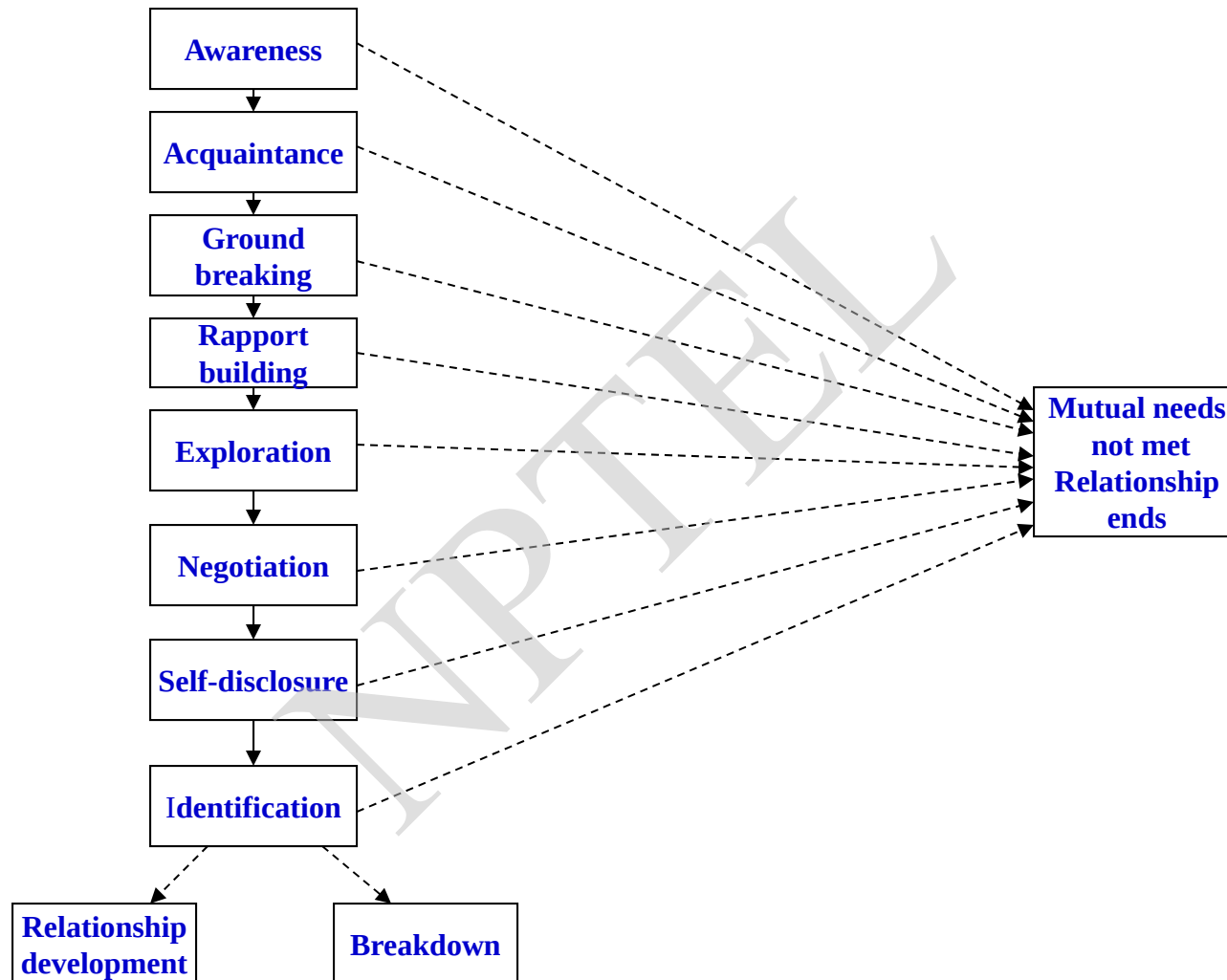
- ☐ **Relationships play an important role in our life.**
- ☐ **There are several characteristics that help to define relationships.**
- ☐ **Relationships influence our behaviour, goals, and attitudes.**
- ☐ **The formulation of relationships depends on communication.**

Characteristics of a Relationship:

- Relationships mold people.
- Relationships are subject to human problems.
- Relationships are transitory
 - (a) *Deep*
 - (b) *Moderate*
 - (c) *Casual*
 - (d) *Passing*
- Relationship Rules cannot be formulated.

Characteristics of a Relationship:

- • Relationship influence people
 - (a) *Goals*
 - (b) *Attitudes*
 - (c) *Behaviour*
- Relationships are activated through communication.



Stages in the Formation of a Relationship:

- **Awareness**
- **Acquaintance**
- **Ground breaking**
- **Rapport building**
- **Exploration:**
 - (a) Seeking information*
 - (b) Giving information*

Stages in the Formation of a Relationship:

- **Negotiation**
- **Self-disclosure:**
 - (a) Formation of bonds*
 - (b) Reduced need for further testing*
- **Identification:**
 - (a) Efforts made to determine the partner's needs.*
 - (b) Efforts made to fulfil the partner's needs.*
- **Breakdown**

What you look for in relationships:

- **You look for someone like yourself.**
- **You look for people who can do something for you.**
- **You look for someone who can help keep you in balance.**
- **You look for someone who is dynamic and sociable.**

Thank You !

Understanding Group Dynamics (part 1)

by

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What is Group Dynamics?

- Group dynamics consists of two words group and dynamics. Group is basically a collectivity of two or more people. Dynamics comes from a *Greek* word which means FORCE. Thus, the group dynamics is concerned of interaction of forces amongst group members in social situations.

What is Group Dynamics?

- **Group dynamics deals with the attitudes and behavioral patterns of a group. Group dynamics concern how groups are formed, what is their structure and which processes are followed in their functioning. Thus, it is concerned with the interactions and forces operating within the group.**
- **A group refers to two or more people who share a common meaning and evaluation of themselves and come together to achieve common goals. In other words, a group is a collection of people who interact with one another; accept rights and obligations as members and who share a common identity.**

Group Dynamics

- Further, group dynamics is a system of behaviours and psychological processes occurring within a social group (*intragroup* dynamics), or between social groups (*intergroup* dynamics). This study can be useful in understanding decision-making behavior in area of common interest.
- Group dynamics are also at the core of understanding racism, sexism, and other forms of social prejudice and discrimination. These applications of the field are studied in psychology, sociology, anthropology, political science, education, social work, business, and communication studies.

Group Dynamics

- Scholars traditionally agree that a simple assembly or collection of people is not really a “group” unless they have a *common purpose*.
- People in groups are organized, have awareness of one another as members of the same group, and carry out communication amongst themselves.

Group versus Team

- The word 'group' and 'team' are used generally, interchangeably. But there are distinct differences between group and team. For example, we have a cricket team, not a cricket group - or we have a special interest group, not a special interest team.
- The main difference is that a team's strength or focus depends on the commonality of their purpose and how the individuals are connected to one another. On the other hand, a group can come from having a large number of people or a cohesive willingness to carry out a focused action. A *group* is a number of individuals forming a unit for a reason or cause, and a *team* is a collection of accomplished people coming together for a common goal that needs completion.

Characteristics of a Group

- **Regardless of the size or the purpose, every group has similar characteristics, for example:**
 - (a) **Two or more persons**
 - (b) **Formal social structure**
 - (c) **Common fate**
 - (d) **Common goals**
 - (e) **Face-to-face interaction**
 - (f) **Interdependence**
 - (g) **Self-definition as group members**
 - (h) **Recognition by others**

Stages of Group Development

Bruce Tuckman (1965), a psychologist, proposed five stages of group development:

Forming: The group begins to come into existence and seeks guidance and direction from a leader concerning the nature of its task and procedure.

Storming: The group starts the creative process of focusing on its goals but may become entangled in socioemotional and relationship storms and interpersonal conflict between individuals.

Stages of Group Development

- **Norming:** The third stage of group development is marked by a more serious concern about task performance. The dyads/triads begin to open up and seek out other members in the group. Efforts are made to establish various norms for task performance.
- Members begin to take greater responsibility for their own group and relationship. Once this stage is complete, a clear picture will emerge about hierarchy of leadership. The norming stage is over with the solidification of the group structure and a sense of group identity and camaraderie.

Stages of Group Development

- **Performing:** This is a stage of a fully functional group where members see themselves as a group and get involved in the task. Each person makes a contribution and the authority figure is also seen as a part of the group. Group norms are followed and collective pressure is exerted to ensure the process of group effectiveness.
- The group may redefine its goal development in the light of information from the outside environment and show an autonomous will to pursue those goals. At this stage, the long-term viability of the group is established and nurtured.

Stages of Group Development

- **Adjourning:** In the case of temporary groups, like project team, task force, or any other such group, which have a limited task at hand, also have a fifth stage, This is known as adjourning.
- Sometimes, group decides to disband. Some members may feel happy over the performance, and some may be unhappy over the stoppage of meeting with group members. Adjourning may also be referred to as mourning, (i.e., mourning the adjournment of the group).
- Here it may be noted that this four stages of group development mentioned above for permanent groups are merely suggestive. In reality, several stages may go on simultaneously.

Fisher's Model of Group Progression

- **Orientation:** The group member gets to know one another and come to grips with the problem they have convened to deal with.
- **Conflict:** The group argues about the possible ways of approaching the problem and begins to find solutions.
- **Emergence:** Developed from the previous stage, emergence occurs when some daylight of consensus begins to dawn and the group starts to move towards agreement.
- **Reinforcement:** The group recognizes that it is reaching consensus and explicitly consolidates that consensus to complete the task.

To continue in part 2...



APTEL

Understanding Group Dynamics Part 2

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Types of Groups

- Groups can be divided into two parts: formal and informal. While formal groups are established by an organization to achieve its goals, informal groups merge spontaneously. Formal groups may take the form of:
 - **command groups**
 - **task groups**
 - **and functional groups**

Command Groups

- **Command groups are specified by the organizational chart and often consist of a supervisor and the subordinates that report to that supervisor. An example of a command group is a market research firm CEO and the research associates under him/her.**

Task Groups

- **Task groups consist of people who work together to achieve a common task. Members are brought together to accomplish a narrow range of goals within a specified time period. Task groups are also commonly referred to as task forces. The organization appoints members and assigns the goals and tasks to be accomplished.**
- **Examples of assigned tasks are the development of a new product, the improvement of a production process, or designing the syllabus under semester system.**
- **Other common task groups are ad hoc committees, project groups, and standing committees. Ad hoc committees are temporary groups created to resolve a specific complaint.**

Functional Groups

- A functional group is created by the organization to accomplish specific goals within an unspecified time frame. Functional groups remain in existence after achievement of current goals and objectives. Examples of functional groups would be a marketing department, a customer service department, or an accounting department.
- Further, informal groups can have a strong influence in organizations that can either be positive or negative. For example, employees who form an informal group can either discuss how to improve a production process or how to create shortcuts that jeopardize quality. Informal groups can take the form of interest groups, friendship groups, or reference groups.

Interest Group

- **Interest groups usually continue over time and may last longer than general informal groups. Members of interest groups may not be part of the same organizational department but they are bound together by some other common interest.**
- **The goals and objectives of group interests are specific to each group and may not be related to organizational goals and objectives. An example of an interest group would be students who come together to form a study group for a specific class.**

Friendship Groups

- Friendship groups are formed by members who enjoy similar social activities, political beliefs, religious values, or other common bonds. Members enjoy each other's company and often meet after work to participate in these activities.
- For example, a group of employees who form a friendship group may have a yoga group, a Telugu association in Kolkata, or a kitty party lunch once in a month.

Reference Groups

- A reference group is a type of group that people use to evaluate themselves. The main objectives of reference groups are to seek social validation and social comparison. Social validation allows individuals to justify their attitudes and values while social comparison helps individuals evaluate their own actions by comparing themselves to others.
- Reference groups have a strong influence on members' behaviour. Such groups are formed voluntarily. Family, friends, and religious affiliations are strong reference groups for most individuals.

Factors Affecting Group Behaviour

- The success or failure of a group depends upon many factors, such as:
- **group member resources**, (structure, group size, group roles, group norms, and group cohesiveness)
- **group processes** (the communication, group decision making processes, power dynamics, conflicting interactions, etc.)
- and **group tasks** (complexity and interdependence).

- The members' knowledge, abilities, skills, and personality characteristics (sociability, self-reliance, and independence) are the resources the group members bring in with them. The success depends upon these resources as useful to the task.

1. Group Member Resources

2. Group Structure

- **Group Size:** Group size can vary from 2 people to a very large number of people. Small groups of two to ten are thought to be more effective because each member has ample opportunity to take part and engage actively in the group. Large groups may waste time by deciding on processes and trying to decide who should participate next.
- **Group Roles:** In formal groups, roles are always predetermined and assigned to members. Each role shall have specific responsibilities and duties. There are, however, emergent roles that develop naturally to meet the needs of the groups.

2. Group Structure

- **Group Norms:** Norms define the acceptable standard or boundaries of acceptable and unacceptable behaviour, shared by group members. They are typically created in order to facilitate group survival, make behaviour more predictable, avoid embarrassing situations, and express the values of the group.
- **Group Cohesiveness:** Cohesiveness refers to the bonding of group members or unity, feelings of attraction for each other and desire to remain part of the group. Many factors influence the amount of group cohesiveness – agreement on group goals, frequency of interaction, personal attractiveness, inter-group competition, favourable evaluation, etc.

3. Group Processes

- **Decision-making by a group is superior, because group generates more information and knowledge, generates diverse alternatives, increases acceptance of a solution, and increases legitimacy. Processes also include communication, conflict management, and leadership.**

Conclusion

- Thus it can be concluded that the group dynamics is essential to study because it helps to find how the relationships are made within the group and how the forces act within the group members. This helps to recognize the formation of the group and also tells how the group should be organized, lead and promoted.

Conclusion (contd...)

- **Group behaviour is unique in nature. In longer-term, groups not simply focus on the completion of a particular task in a specific time frame, but people would like to move from formal and superficial talk towards deeper and meaningful personal talk. They will have self-disclosure, and will also focus their talk on any tasks or objectives the group has in front of it.**

Groups, Conflicts and their Resolution

(A Communication Skills Approach)

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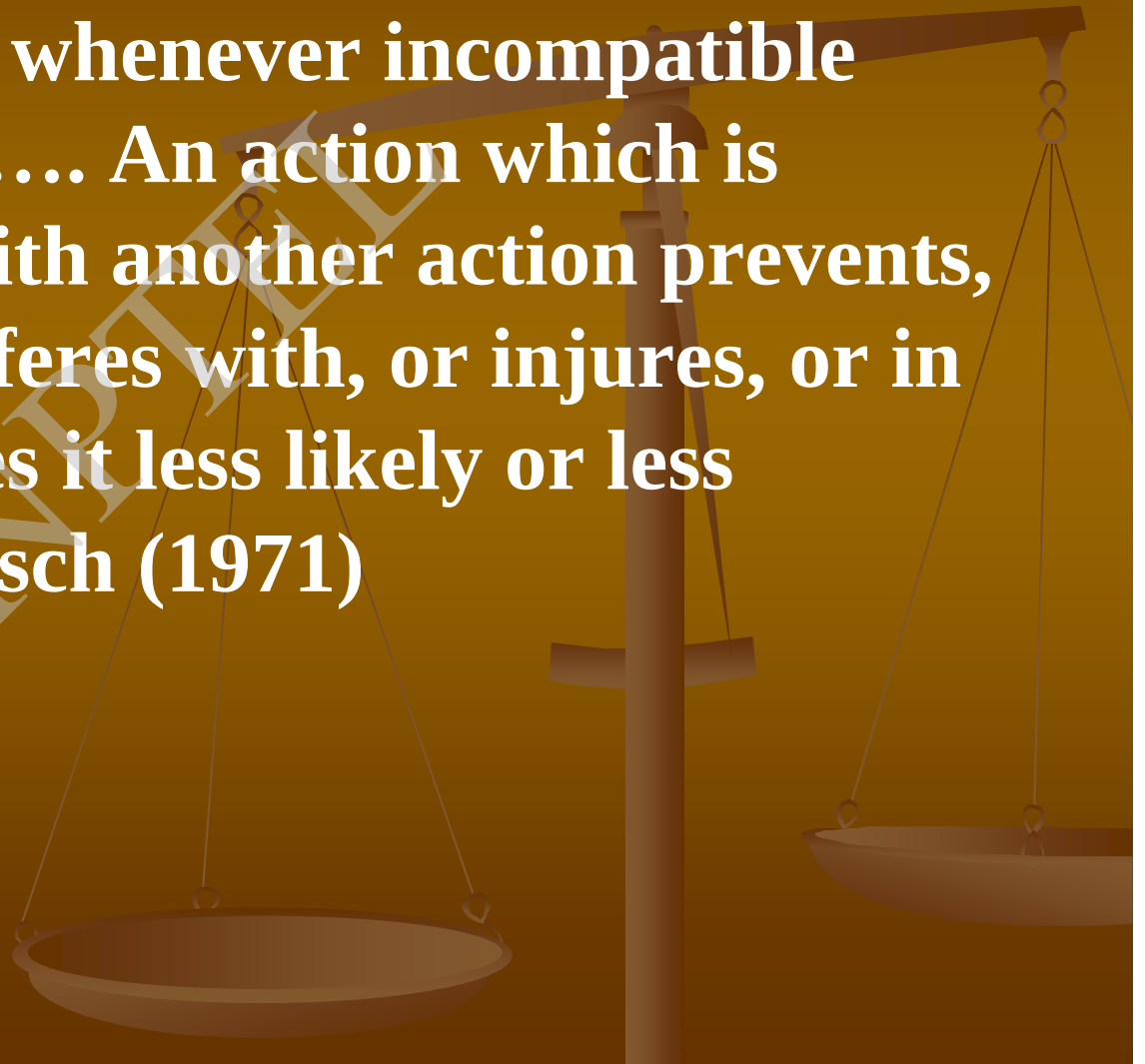
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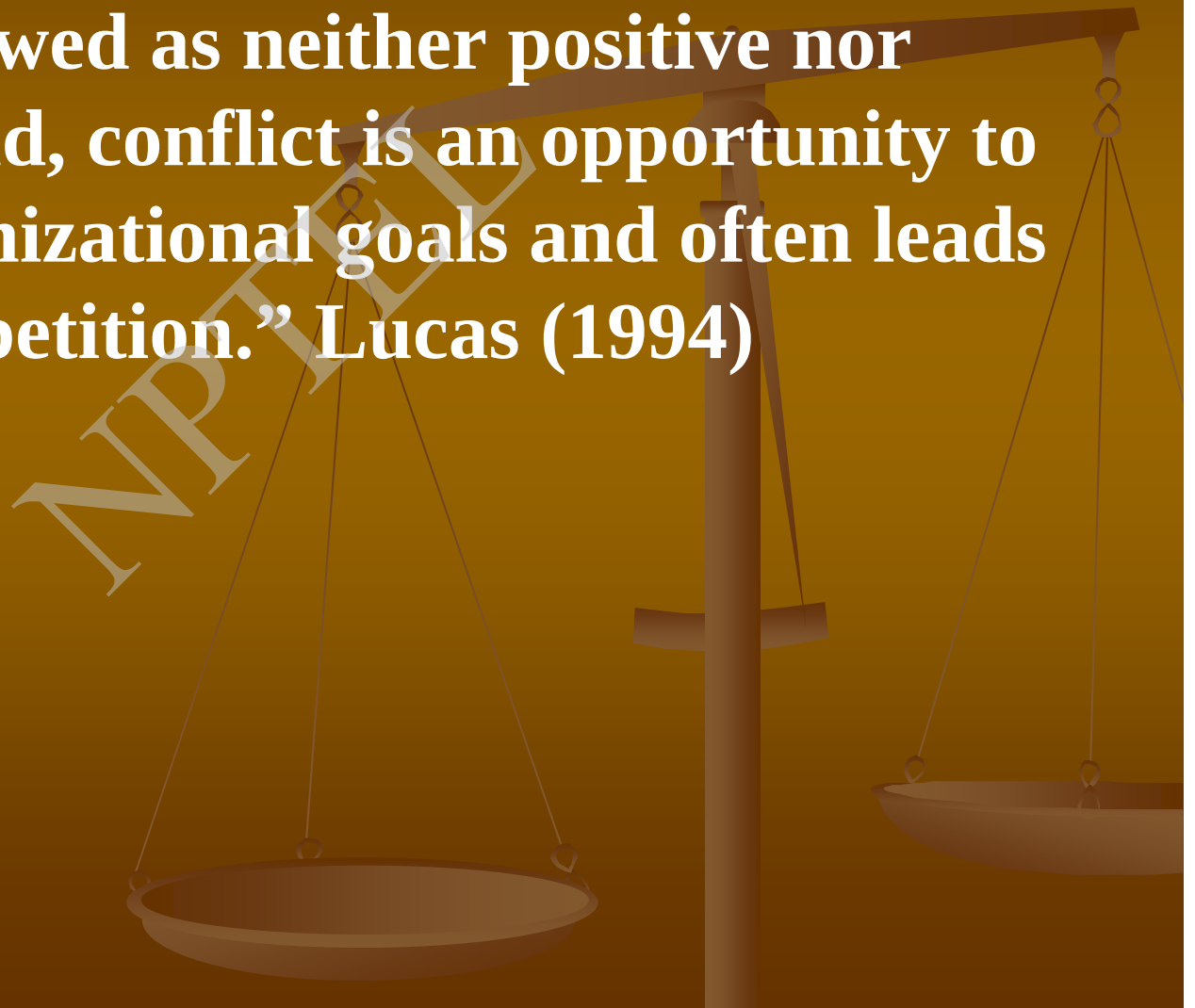


Conflict Defined

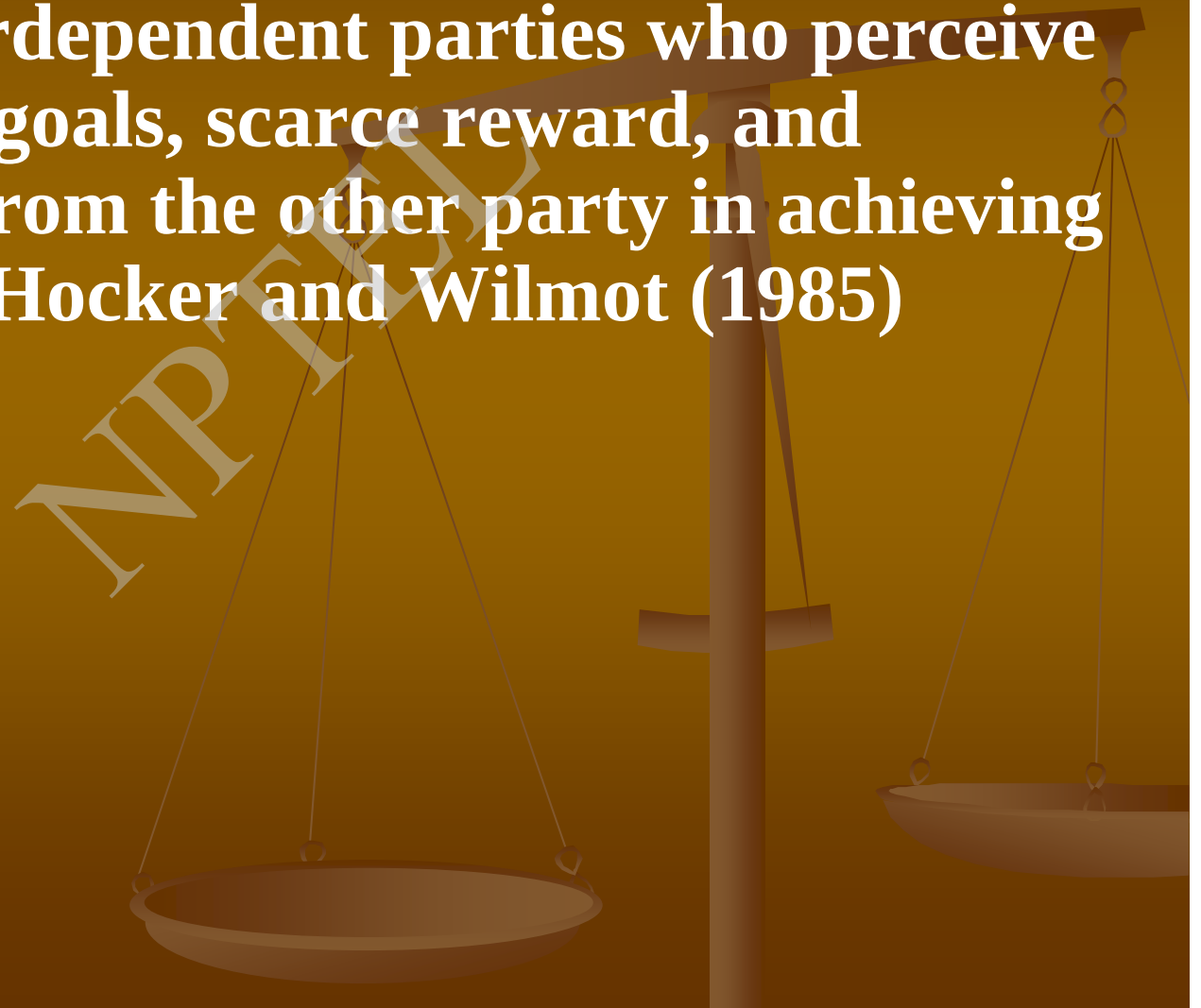
- “Conflict exists whenever incompatible activities occur.... An action which is incompatible with another action prevents, obstructs, interferes with, or injures, or in some way makes it less likely or less effective.” Deutsch (1971)



- **“Conflict often results when two or more people, departments or organizations disagree. It should be viewed as neither positive nor negative. Instead, conflict is an opportunity to help meet organizational goals and often leads to healthy competition.” Lucas (1994)**



- **“Conflict is an expressed struggle between at least two interdependent parties who perceive incompatible goals, scarce reward, and interference from the other party in achieving their goals.” Hocker and Wilmot (1985)**

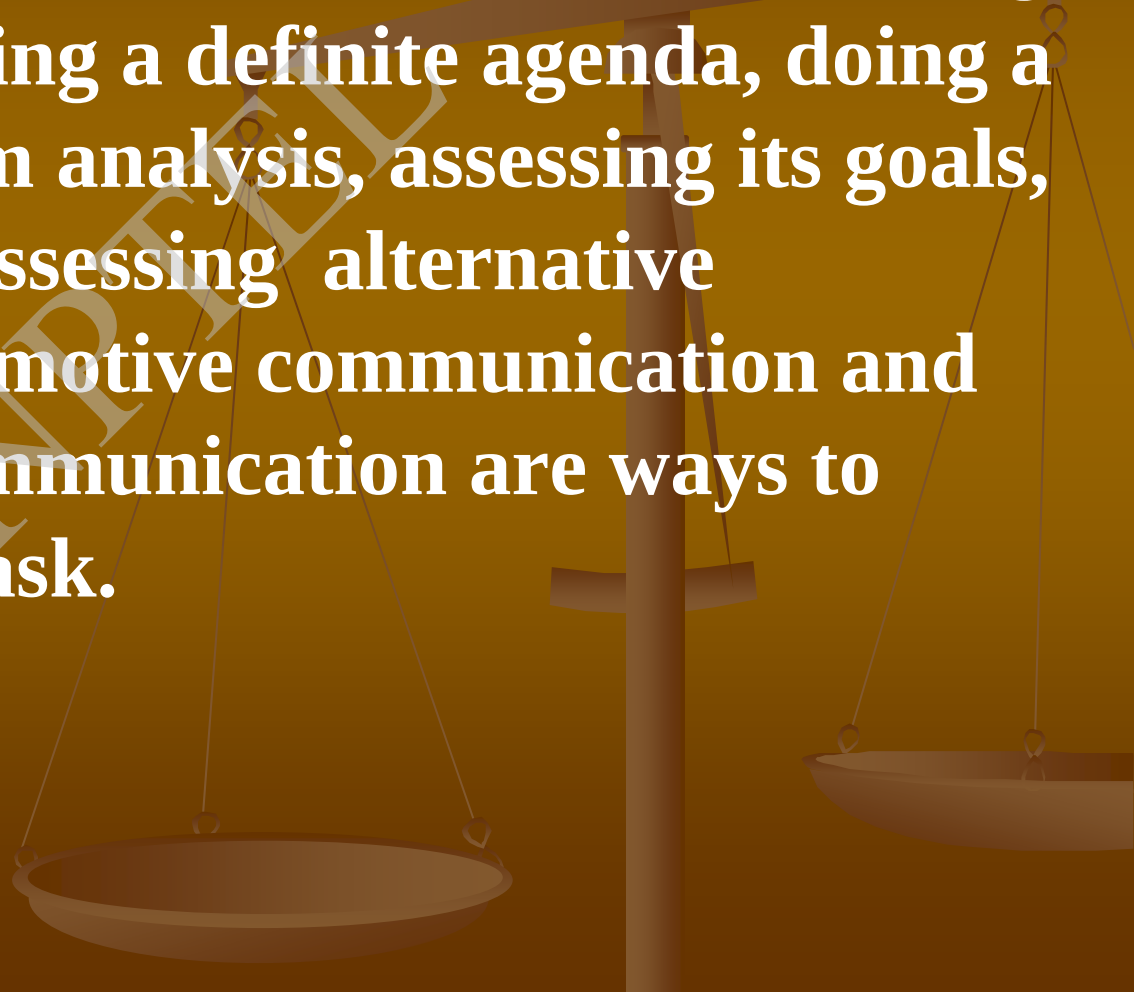


Groups

- A group may be regarded as an organized structure composed of individuals having a common purpose, interdependence, and division of labour. Group members are aware of one another and communicate about the common goal.
- Group communication is all about everyday talk and relationships, especially the relationships between people. Relationships matter a lot in the functioning of the group.
- Whenever, conflicts happens in the groups, it should be seen not simply as a *battle of ideas* but as a *battle between people who have ideas*.

Groups

- A group can promote its own decision-making capacities by setting a definite agenda, doing a thorough problem analysis, assessing its goals, and thoroughly assessing alternative possibilities. Promotive communication and counteractive communication are ways to keep groups on task.



Types of Conflict

- **Intrapersonal Conflict**
- **Interpersonal Conflict**
- **Intragroup Conflict**
- **Intergroup Conflict**
- **International Conflict**



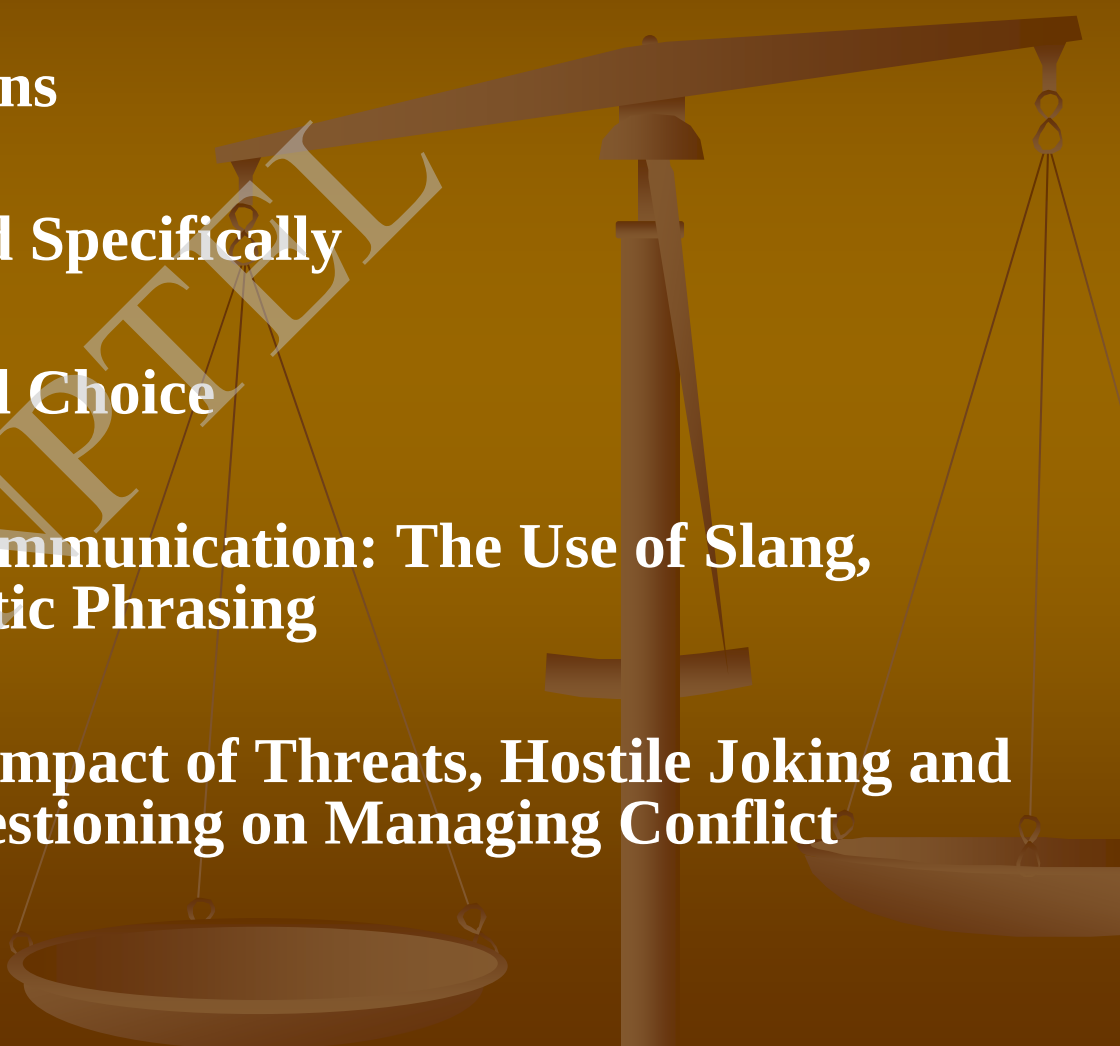
Sources of Conflict

- Differences in Culture
- Differences in Ideology and Values
- Educational Differences
- Differences in Experiences
- Competitions
- Varying Perceptions
- Inadequate or Poor Communication
- Misuse of Power



Verbal Communication Strategies for Conflict Management

1. Descriptive Speech

- **Admitting One's Assertions**
 - **Stating Issues Clearly and Specifically**
 - **Semantic Selection: Word Choice**
 - **Semantic Obstacles to Communication: The Use of Slang, Stereotypes, and Automatic Phrasing**
 - **Syntactic Selection: The Impact of Threats, Hostile Joking and Sarcasm, and Hostile Questioning on Managing Conflict**
- 

2 Problem Orientation

- Identifying the Problem
- Proposing Solutions
- Assessing Solutions

3. Spontaneity

4. Empathy

5. Equality

6. Provisionalism



Nonverbal Communication Strategies for Conflict Management

Types of Nonverbal Communication

- **Appearance**
- **Kinesics**
- **Oculesics**
- **Haptics**
- **Proxemics**



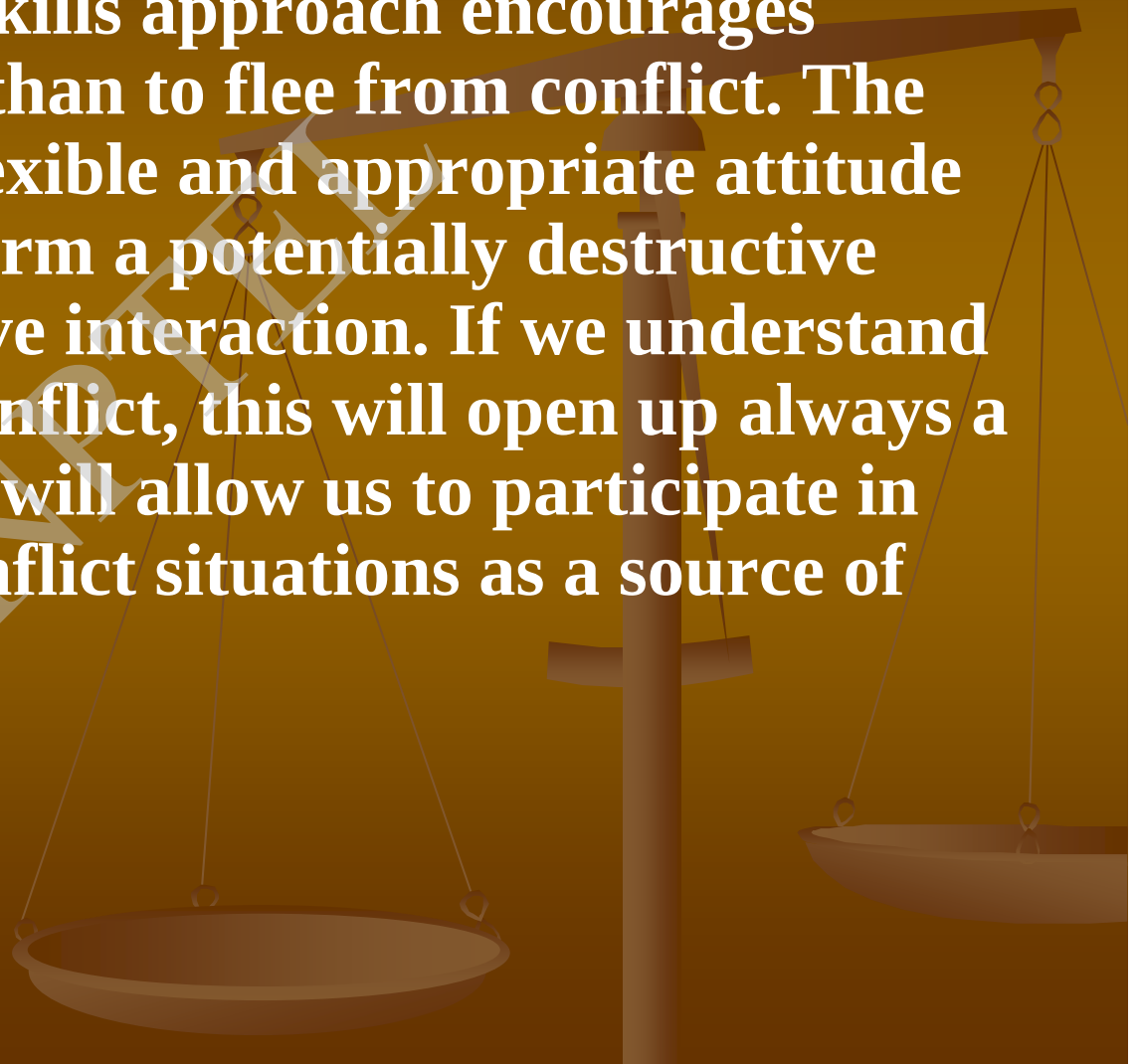
Conflict Handling Styles

- **Avoiding Style**
- **Forcing Style**
- **Accommodating Style**
- **Collaborative Style**
- **Compromising Style**



Conclusion

- **The communication skills approach encourages people to face rather than to flee from conflict. The ability to develop a flexible and appropriate attitude to conflict can transform a potentially destructive situation into a positive interaction. If we understand properly to resolve conflict, this will open up always a new opportunity that will allow us to participate in and even embrace conflict situations as a source of change and growth.**



Thank you!



Social network, media and extending our identities

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*MOOC
Soft skills
development*

Overview

- Networking skills
- Significance
- Definition
- Levels of analysis
- Relevance
- Networking on the net
- Social media
- Components
- Relevance and implications
- Summing up

Networking skills

- Mindset – link to listening and speaking - positive
- Purpose – some motivation – link to goal
- Who should you get in touch with – map
- Human interaction – link to conversation skills
 - Make friends not contacts
 - Friends with connected people
 - Follow up – maintain contacts
- Know what not to do

Why network?

- Without collaboration we would not survive...
- How deeply networked we really are: an example from *Naked Economics*, Charles Wheelan, 2010.
- Civilization, individualism, and the disconnect.
- What are clubs and forums for?

- Relationships
- Understanding relationships
- The bird's eye view
- The God's eye view

Definition

- A **social network** is a social structure made up of a set of social actors (such as individuals or organizations), sets of dyadic ties, and other social interactions between actors. The social network perspective provides a set of methods for analyzing the structure of whole social entities as well as a variety of theories explaining the patterns observed in these structures. (Wikipedia)

- Micro level – individuals or small groups
- Meso level – organizations, etc...
- Macro level – large scale networks
- The social network is a theoretical construct useful in the social sciences to study relationships between individuals, groups, organizations, or even entire societies (Wikipedia)

Relevance

- How people behave in small and large networks
 - Six degrees of separation
 - Who is influential
 - What interactions take place
- Why do they behave so
 - Language
 - Culture
 - Cognitive and emotive factors
- How to modify behavior
 - Influence
 - Predictions
 - Creating biases
 - Manipulation and propaganda

- “Social networking is the practice of expanding the number of one's business and/or social contacts by making connections through individuals.

Net networking

- “While social networking has gone on almost as long as societies themselves have existed, the unparalleled potential of the Web to facilitate such connections is only now being fully recognized and exploited, through Web-based groups established for that purpose.” (Social Networking. *WhatIs.com*)

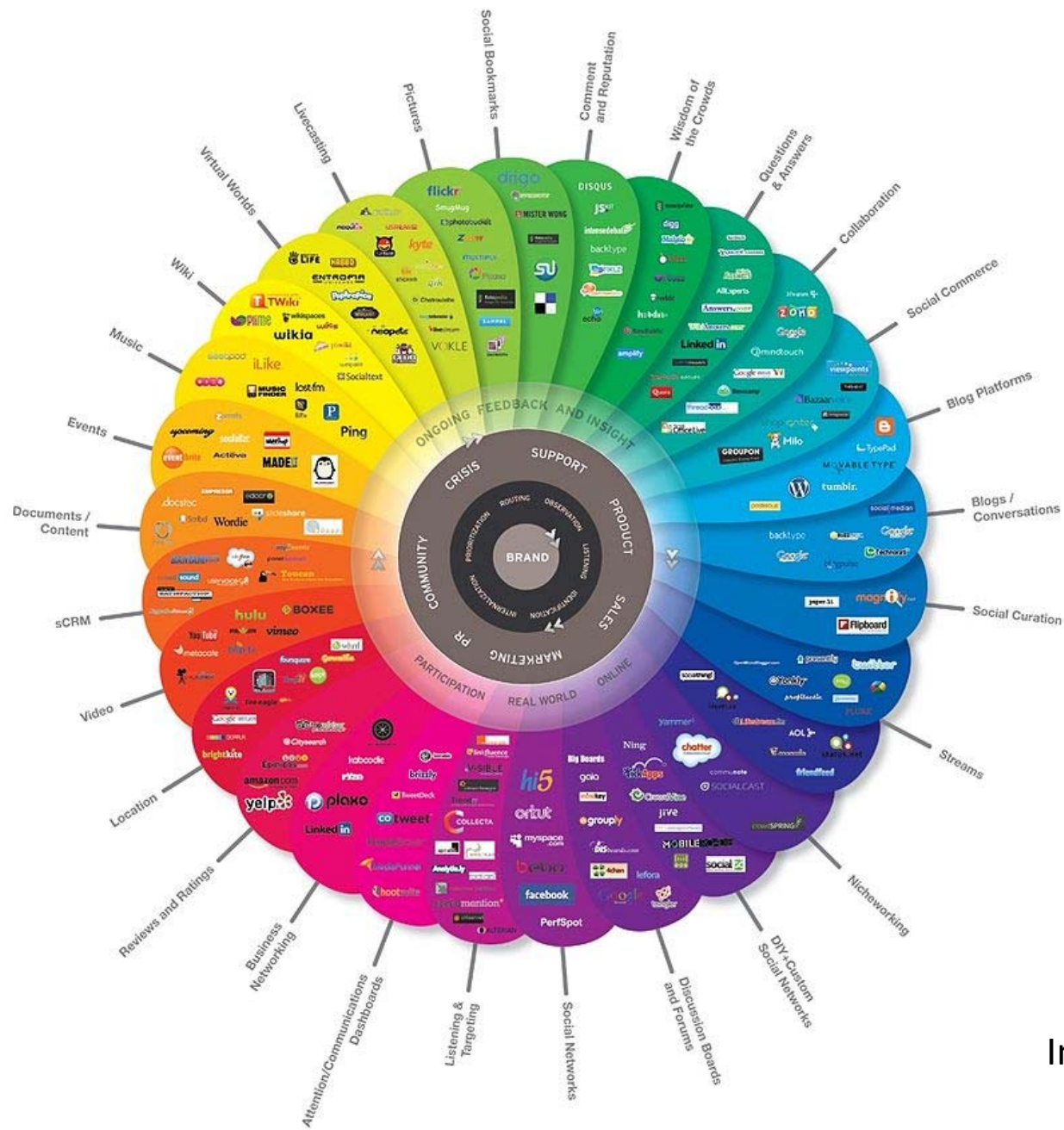


Image source: "Social Media," Wikipedia

- **Social media** are *computer-mediated* tools that allow people, companies and other organizations to *create, share, or exchange information*, career interests, ideas, and pictures/videos in virtual communities and networks.

Social media

(Wikipedia)

- Blogs
- Forums
- Photo-sharing
- Social gaming
- Video sharing
- Virtual worlds...

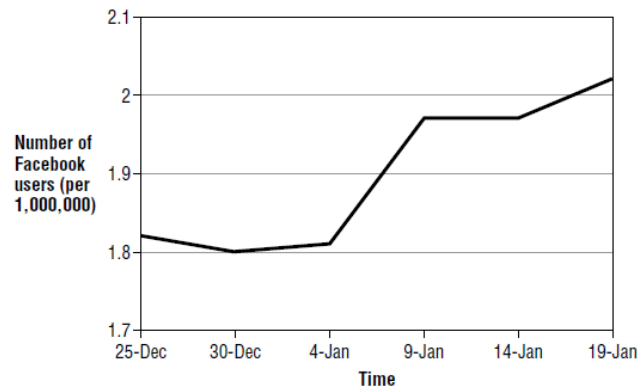
New rules and relations

- Virality
- Location sensitive
- Time sensitive
- Identity
- Sharing
- Group formations
- Collaboration

- Authority
- Creativity
- Identity formation
- Public opinion
- History and authenticity
- Effects on interpersonal relationships...(real-life socializing...)

Relevance

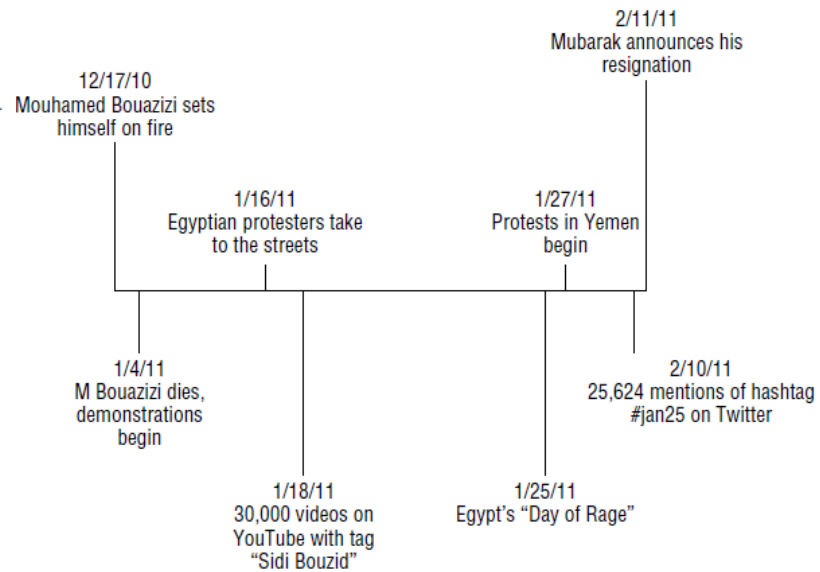
- **Facebook:** “Facebook’s News Feed is arguably the single most important information source on earth: the place where a startling 1.09 billion people turn daily for everything from breaking news to baby pictures.” (*Washington Post*, June 2016)



Source: Socialbakers.com (2012) "Tunisia: Country Reports: Twitter/Facebook." Accessed: 25 April 2012. <http://www.socialbakers.com/facebook-statistics/tunisia>

Figure 1.1: Tunisian Facebook growth in late 2010–early 2011

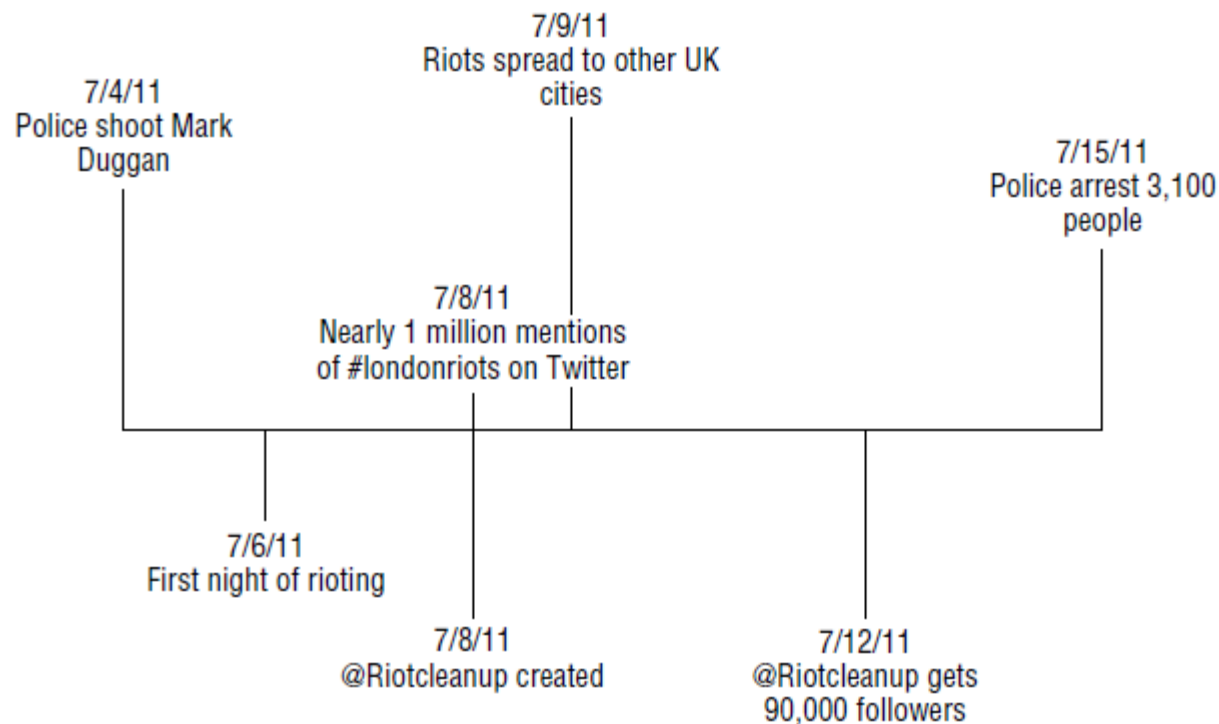
Gupta and Brooks, 2013



Note: Not a detailed timeline, includes only some key events

Sources: Council on Foreign Relations. (2011) *The New Arab Revolt: What Happened, What it Means, and What Comes Next*. CFR, New York; Wright, R. (2011) *Rock the Casbah: Rage and Rebellion Across the Islamic World*. Simon & Shuster, New York.

Figure 1.2: Early Arab Spring timeline



Note: Not a detailed timeline, includes only some key events

Sources: Guardian (2011) "Datablog: Data Journalism During the Riots: What We Know. What We Don't."

Accessed 25 April 2012.

<http://www.guardian.co.uk/news/datablog/2011/dec/09/data-journalism-reading-riots>;

Mashable.com (2011) "London Riots and Twitter." Accessed 25 April 2012.

<http://mashable.com/2011/08/09/london-riots-twitter/> ; Stone, Z. (2011) "Retweet to Rebuild:

Social Media Helps Clean Up London Post-Riots." Good Culture. Accessed: 14 August 2012.

<http://www.good.is/post/retweet-to-rebuild-social-media-is-helping-cleanup-london-post-riots/>

Figure 1.4: 2011 London riots timeline

Gupta and Brooks, 2013

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